

CHALLENGE #18: Roboto Sans Write-up.

Roboto Sans

Medium

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2022

AUTHOR: MUBARAK MIKAIL

Description

The flag is somewhere on this web application not necessarily on the website. Find it.

Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is:

NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

Hints

(None)

27,258 users solved

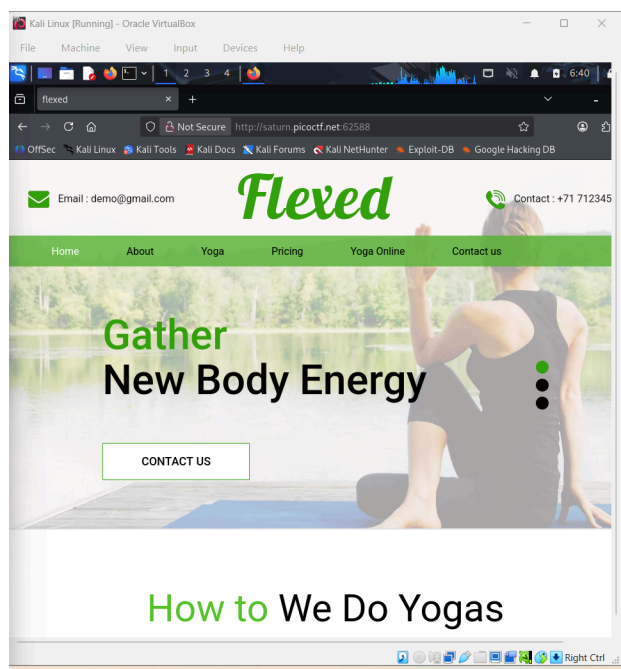
49% Liked

🚩

picoCTF{FLAG}

Submit Flag

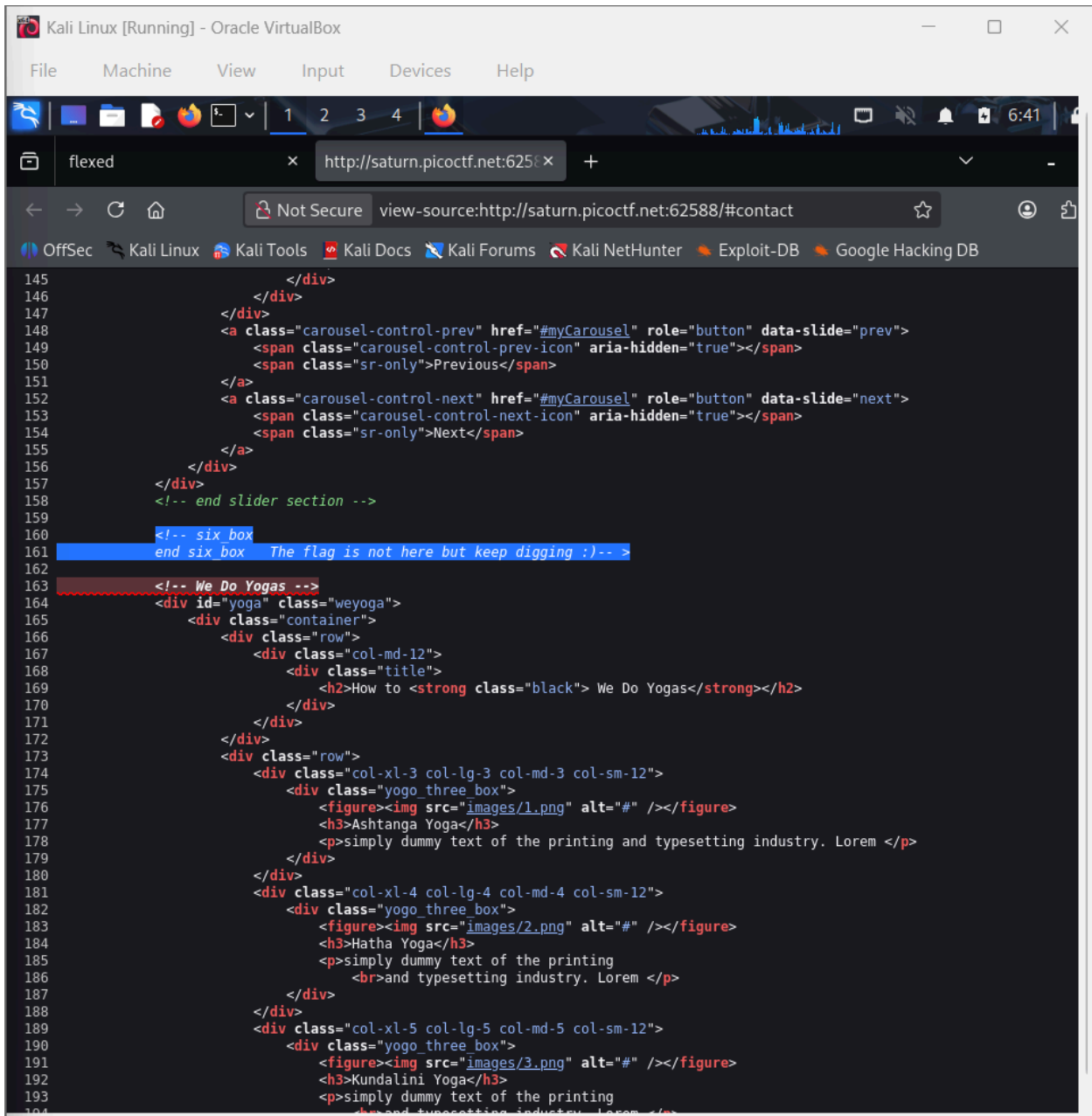
Solving Process:



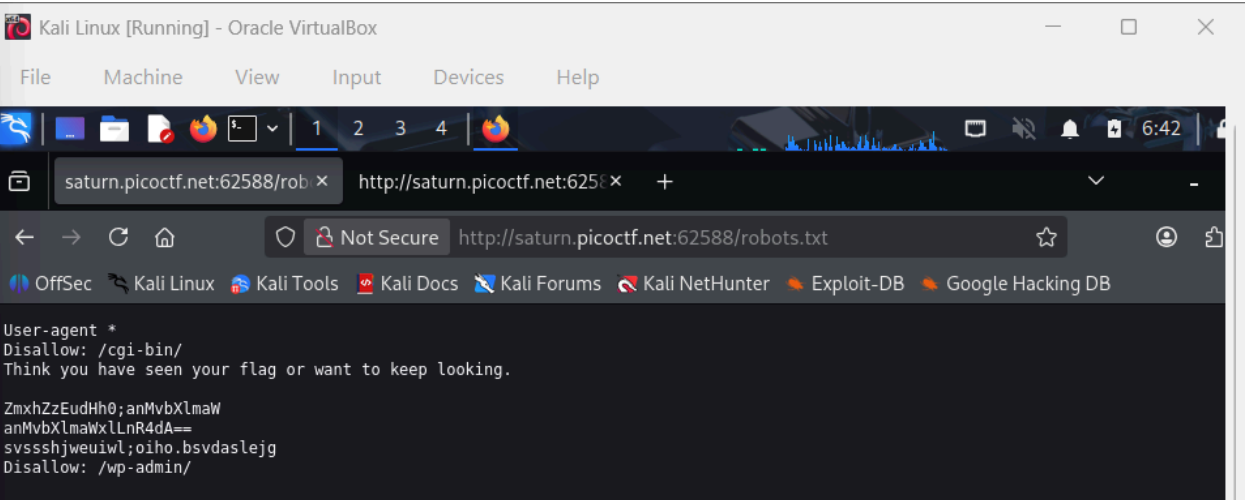
The page appeared to be a simple webpage with several navigation buttons, such as Home, About, Yoga, Pricing, and Contact Us. However, most of these buttons either did nothing or simply redirected to another section of the same page. This suggested that the visible interface of the website did not directly contain the flag.

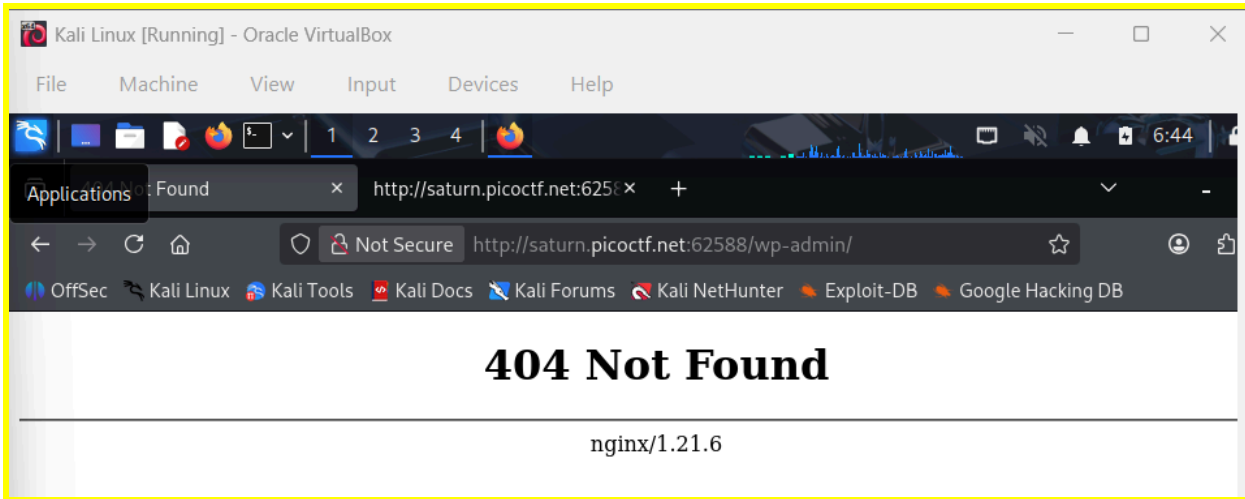
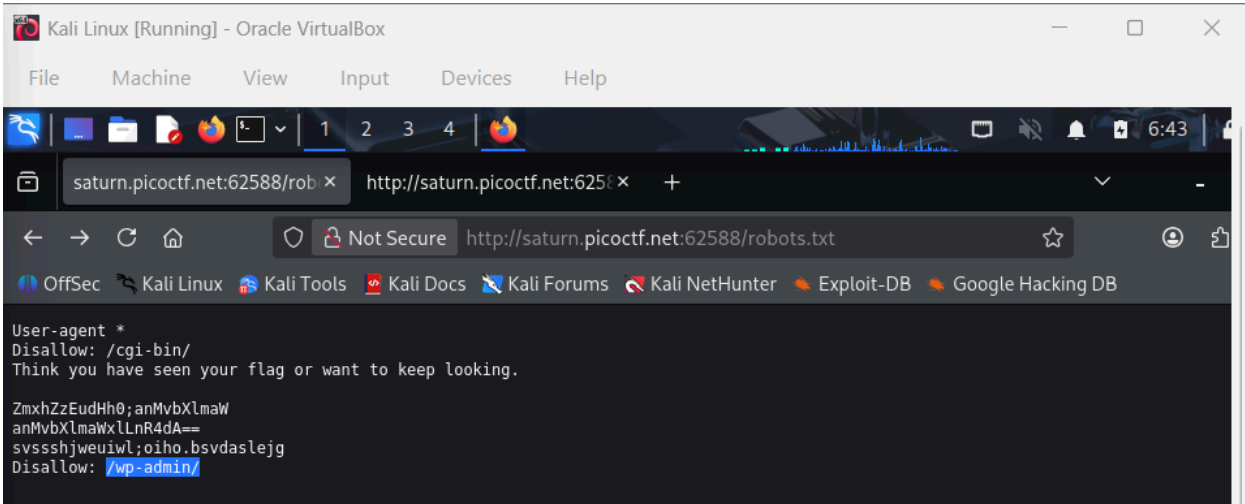
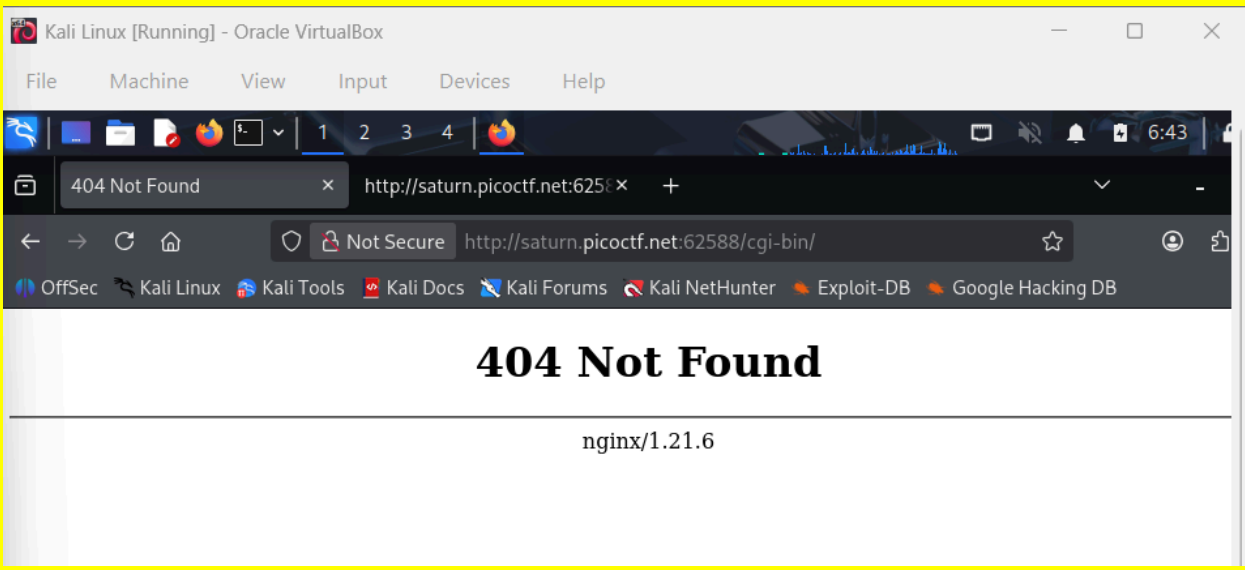
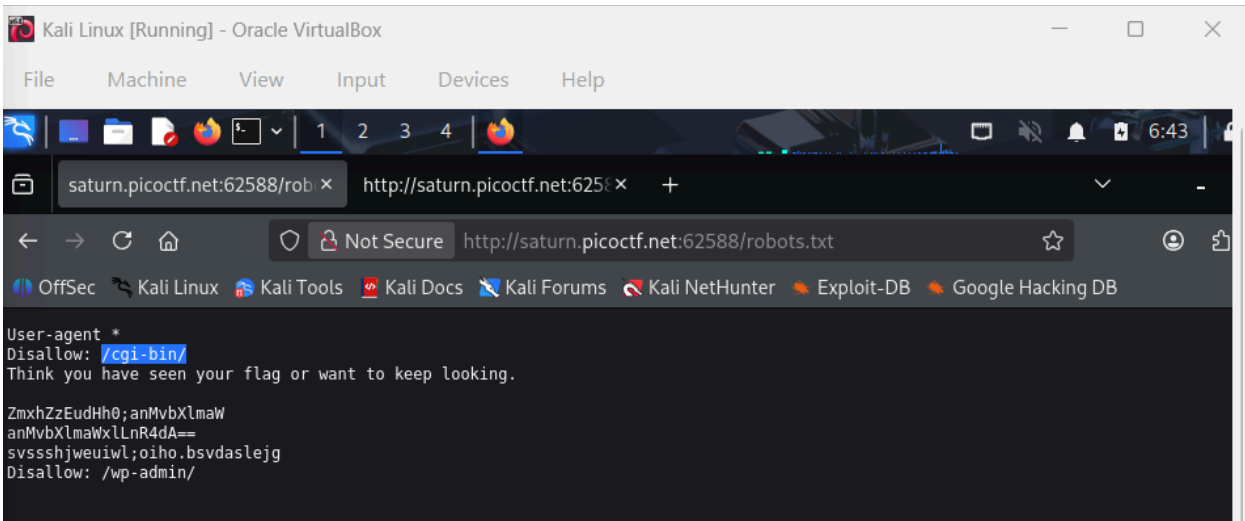
The name of the challenge, “**Roboto Sans**,” seemed similar to the term **Roboto**, which is a font commonly used in websites. However, another possible interpretation was that it referred to the **robots.txt** file, which is commonly used in web applications to control which pages search engine crawlers are allowed or not allowed to access.

Before investigating that possibility, the page source of the website was examined. While reviewing the HTML code, an internal comment was found stating that **“the flag is not here but keep digging.”** This confirmed that the flag was hidden somewhere else within the web application.

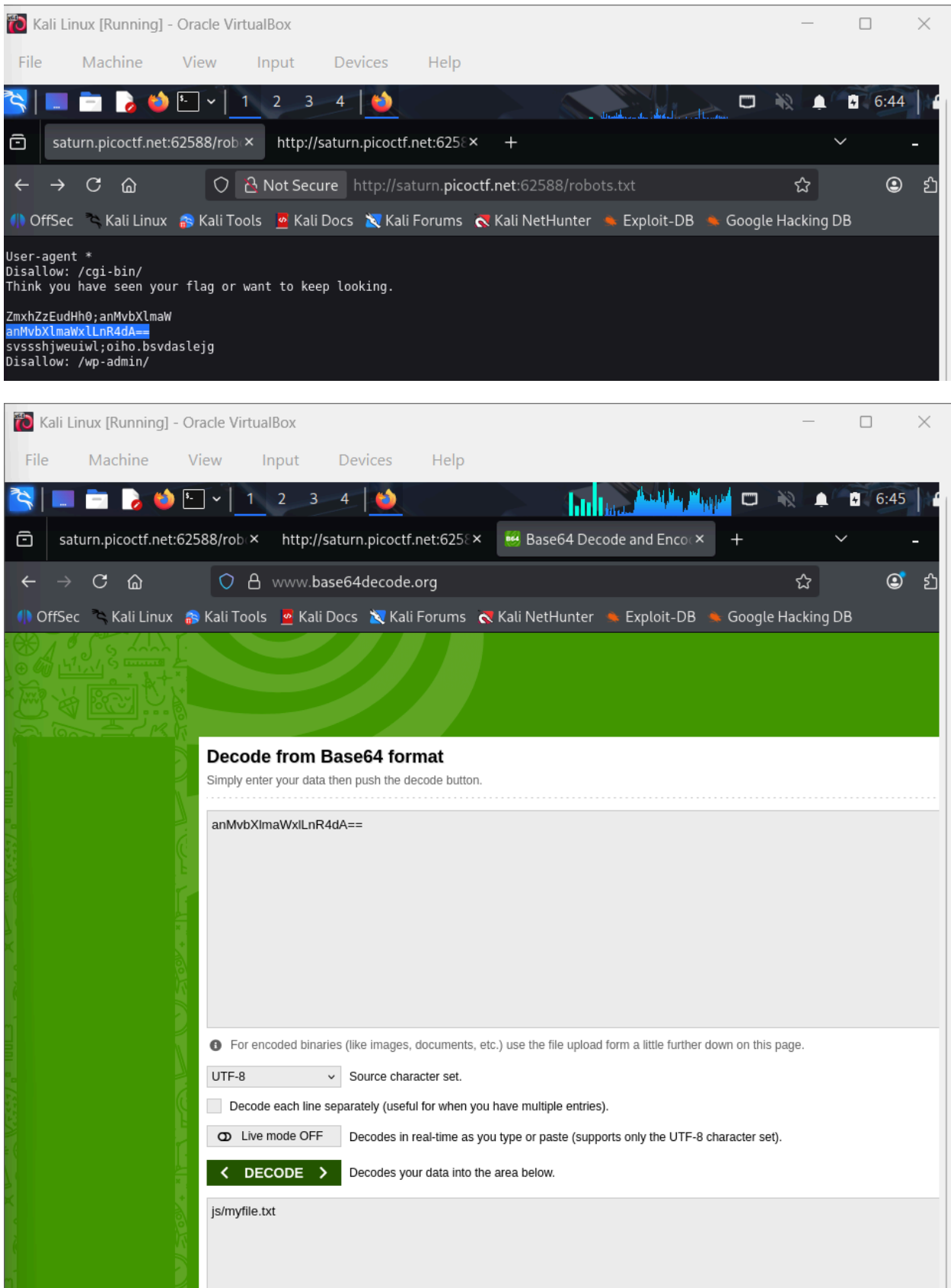


Next, the possibility of a **robots.txt** file was tested by manually appending `/robots.txt` to the website's URL. The robots.txt file was successfully opened and contained several disallowed paths, along with another comment hinting that the flag might still require further searching.



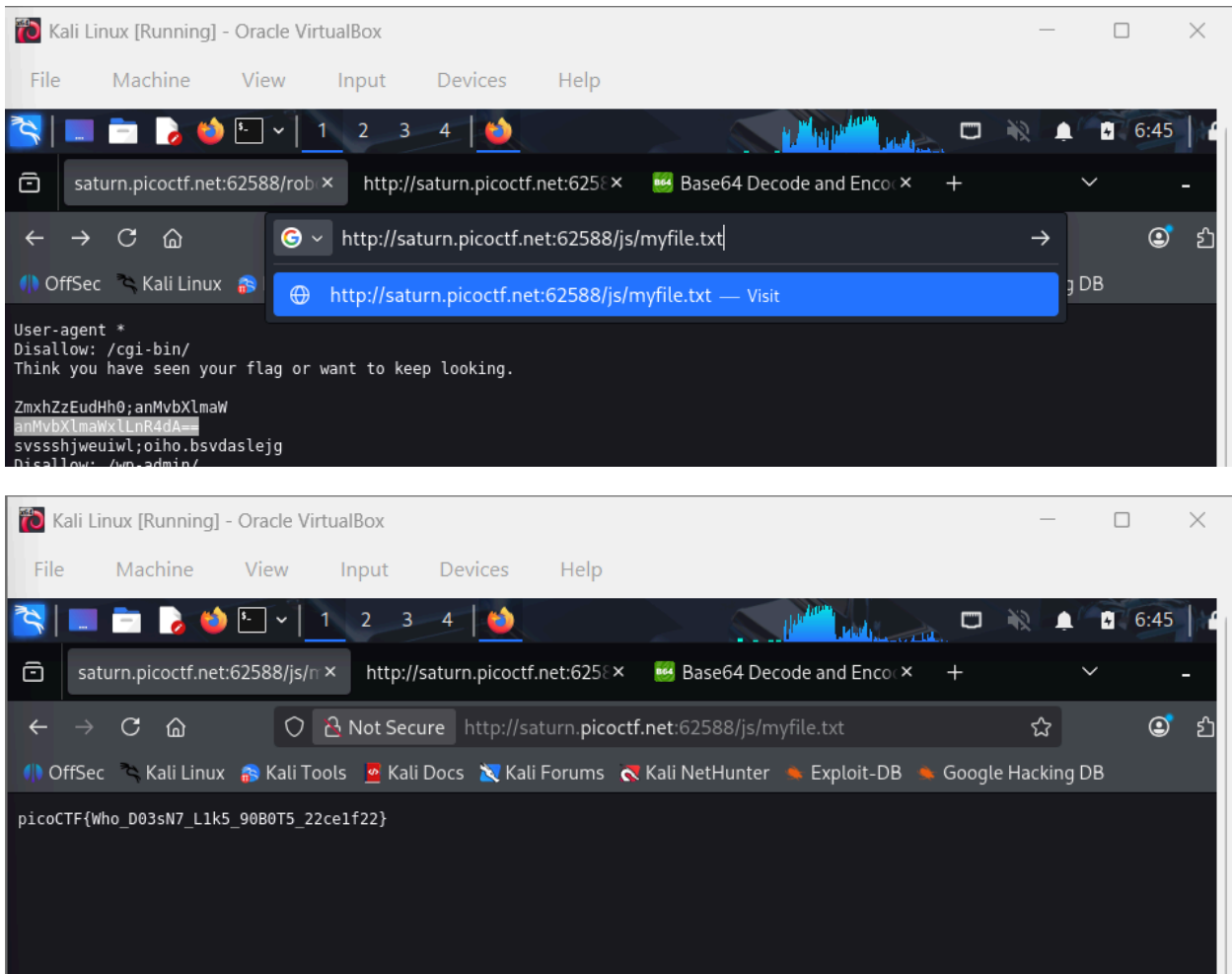


Among the contents of the robots.txt file, a string of seemingly random characters stood out because it ended with **two equal signs (==)**, which is commonly seen in Base64 encoded strings. Since Base64 encoding is frequently used in CTF challenges to hide information, the string was copied and decoded using an online Base64 decoder.



After decoding the string, it revealed another file path located inside the JS directory, specifically pointing to a file named **myfile.txt**. This path was then appended to the website's URL and opened in the browser.

When the file was accessed, its contents displayed the flag, confirming that the hidden resource had been successfully discovered.



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Hurray! You solved this challenge.

AUTHOR: MUBARAK MIKAIL

Description

The flag is somewhere on this web application not necessarily on the website. Find it.

Check [this](#) out.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: RUNNING

Instance Time Remaining: 8:17

Restart Instance

Hints

(None)

27,258 users solved

49%

Liked

picoCTF{Who_D03sN7_L1k5_90B0T5_22ce1f22}

Submit Flag

Reflection:

This challenge demonstrated the importance of exploring hidden web resources such as robots.txt files and encoded strings during web security investigations. By analyzing hints in the source code and decoding Base64 data, it was possible to uncover hidden directories that were not directly visible on the website. The activity highlighted how simple obfuscation techniques can hide sensitive information if not properly secured.